NATIONAL INNOVATORS BATTLE (NIB) 2026

PARTICIPANT GUIDELINES, RULES & REGULATIONS

Future Innovators – Junior & Senior Categories

Theme: Learn • Build • Innovate • Compete

Grand Finale: 20 December 2026
Venue: National Innovators Battle (NIB) Arena Hall, Lucknow, Uttar Pradesh
Registration Deadline: 15 December 2026
Official Website: www.nibindia.org

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1. COMPETITION STRUCTURE

The Future Innovators competition will be conducted in two rounds, followed by the Physical Grand Finale.

Round 1 – Online Idea Submission

- Participants submit their project ideas online, explaining the problem statement, proposed solution, innovation, and expected social impact.
- Ideas are evaluated by the NIB expert jury.
- Shortlisted teams qualify for the next round.

Round 2 – Detailed Project Development

- Shortlisted teams develop a working prototype of their proposed solution.
- Teams prepare a detailed project report explaining the design, working principle, technology used, functionality, scalability, and practical applications.

Grand Finale – Physical Presentation & Demonstration

- Shortlisted teams present their projects before the expert jury at the NIB Arena Hall.
- Participants demonstrate their working prototypes and explain their innovation.
- Judges evaluate the projects based on the published judging criteria.
- Winners and special award recipients are announced at the Grand Finale.

2. CATEGORIES

The Future Innovators competition will have two divisions:

- **Junior Category:** Grades 4–7
- **Senior Category:** Grades 8–12

Both categories will be evaluated separately to ensure fair competition according to students' grade levels.

3. GENERAL RULES & REGULATIONS

1. Every participating team must complete registration through the official NIB website or the registration link provided by their school.
2. A unique Team ID will be allotted after successful registration. Teams must use this ID for all official communication.
3. Only registered team members are permitted to represent the team during the competition.
4. Participants must report to the venue at the time communicated by the organizers.
5. Each team must bring its working project/prototype, required components, and project report.
6. Teams must arrange their own laptops, chargers, batteries, adapters, and other essential equipment required for demonstrating their projects.
7. Participants must ensure that their projects are safe to operate and do not pose any risk to other participants, visitors, or organizers.
8. Any change in project title, concept, or major functionality after Round 1 should be communicated to the organizers.
9. Projects must be based on the idea submitted and approved during the online evaluation round. Major changes require approval from the organizers.
10. The decision of the NIB jury and organizing committee shall be final and binding.

4. PROJECT PRESENTATION & DEMONSTRATION RULES

1. Each team must present its own working project or prototype.
2. Participants must explain the problem being addressed, the proposed solution, and the innovative aspects of their project.
3. Teams must demonstrate the actual working and functionality of their projects wherever applicable.
4. Participants should clearly explain the technologies, components, sensors, programming, and mechanisms used.

5. Teams must explain the practical applications and potential social impact of their projects.
6. Participants should be prepared to answer technical and problem-related questions from the judges.
7. Each team must prepare a project report containing:
    - Project title and team details.
    - Problem statement.
    - Proposed solution.
    - Innovation and uniqueness.
    - Components and technologies used.
    - Working principle and methodology.
    - Applications and social impact.
    - Future improvements and scalability.
8. Posters, charts, project models, and display materials are permitted, subject to the space allocated by the organizers.
9. Teams must complete their project setup within the allotted time.
10. Participants must not obstruct walkways or disturb other teams during their demonstrations.

5. ORIGINALITY & INNOVATION POLICY

1. All projects must demonstrate students' own understanding, creativity, and contribution.
2. Participants may use existing technologies, open-source platforms, reference materials, and online learning resources.
3. However, simply copying an existing project without meaningful modifications or original contributions is not encouraged.
4. Students must be able to explain the complete working principle of their projects.
5. If two or more projects are found to be substantially identical, the jury may question the teams regarding their individual contributions.
6. Judges may conduct technical interviews to verify students' understanding and originality.
7. Coaches, teachers, and mentors must not answer questions on behalf of participants during evaluation.

8. Any proven case of plagiarism, false claims, or misrepresentation may lead to disqualification.

6. DEVICE & EQUIPMENT RULES

1. Participants may bring laptops, chargers, project components, tools, and other equipment essential for their demonstrations.
2. Mobile phones must remain on silent mode during presentations and judging.
3. USB drives, external storage devices, and other data-transfer equipment may be used only when required for project operation or presentation.
4. Personal hotspots and internet connectivity must be used only when required for the project and permitted by the organizers.
5. Participants must not access another team's laptop, project files, or equipment without permission.
6. The organizers reserve the right to inspect equipment for safety and compliance.
7. Hazardous chemicals, explosives, weapons, unsafe electrical setups, and other dangerous materials are strictly prohibited.

7. CODE OF CONDUCT

Participants, teachers, coaches, and accompanying persons must maintain discipline and sportsmanship throughout the event.

The following activities are strictly prohibited:

- Misbehaving with judges, organizers, participants, volunteers, or visitors.
- Damaging or interfering with another team's project or equipment.
- Disrupting presentations or competition activities.
- Using unfair means to influence the evaluation process.
- Providing false information about project development or functionality.
- Arguing with judges or attempting to influence their decisions.
- Engaging in inappropriate behaviour or activities that disturb the event.

Any serious misconduct may result in penalties, removal from the venue, or disqualification.

8. PHYSICAL ROUND – JUDGING CRITERIA

Each project will be evaluated out of 100 marks by the NIB expert jury.

Evaluation Parameter	Marks

Innovation & Originality	20
Social Impact & Public Welfare	15
Working Model & Functionality	20
Problem Identification & Solution	10
Technical Understanding & Application	10
Presentation & Communication Skills	10
Creativity & Design	5
Practicality & Scalability	5
Safety, Reliability & Execution	5
Total	**100**

What Judges Will Look For

- **Innovation:** How unique and original is the proposed solution?
- **Social Impact:** How effectively can it benefit society or solve a real-world problem?
- **Functionality:** Does the prototype actually work as explained?
- **Problem-Solving:** Does the project address the identified problem effectively?
- **Technical Knowledge:** Do students understand the technologies and components used?
- **Presentation:** Can students explain their project confidently and clearly?
- **Creativity:** Does the project demonstrate thoughtful design and creative thinking?
- **Scalability:** Can the solution be improved or implemented on a larger scale?
- **Safety & Reliability:** Is the project safe, stable, and properly executed?

9. AWARDS & RECOGNITION

Apart from the overall 1st, 2nd, and 3rd position awards, NIB 2026 will recognize outstanding projects through 12 special award categories.

Overall Championship Awards

1. First Position – Winner
2. Second Position – Runner-Up
3. Third Position – Second Runner-Up

Special Recognition Awards

1. **Best Innovative Idea Award** – For the most original and groundbreaking concept.
2. **Best Social Impact Project Award** – For a project with exceptional potential to benefit society.
3. **Best Working Prototype Award** – For the most effective and functional working model.
4. **Best Project Demonstration Award** – For an outstanding live demonstration of project functionality.
5. **Best Presentation Award** – For excellent communication, explanation, and presentation skills.
6. **Best Technical Excellence Award** – For impressive technical knowledge and application.
7. **Best Robotics & Automation Project Award** – For exceptional use of robotics and automation.
8. **Best AI & Emerging Technology Project Award** – For innovative applications of AI, IoT, and emerging technologies.
9. **Best Environmental Innovation Award** – For outstanding solutions addressing environmental challenges.
10. **Best Practical Solution Award** – For a project that offers an effective and implementable real-world solution.
11. **Best Creative Design Award** – For exceptional creativity, engineering design, and project aesthetics.
12. **Most Promising Future Innovation Award** – For an idea with significant potential for future development and scalability.

Special awards will be presented based on jury evaluation and merit. Winning an overall position does not automatically guarantee a special award.

10. IMPORTANT EVENT GUIDELINES

- Participants must follow the reporting time and event schedule.
- Teams must keep their allocated project area clean and organized.
- Participants are responsible for their own project equipment and belongings.
- The organizers will not be responsible for loss, theft, or damage to personal equipment.
- Participants must follow all safety instructions issued by the organizing committee.
- Photography and videography may be conducted during the event for documentation and promotional purposes.

- Any changes to the competition schedule or rules will be communicated through official NIB communication channels.

11. DISQUALIFICATION & PENALTIES

The organizing committee reserves the right to issue warnings, impose penalties, or disqualify teams for:

- Plagiarism or deliberate copying without original contribution.
- Providing false project information.
- Misconduct or indiscipline.
- Interfering with other participants or projects.
- Unsafe project operation.
- Violation of competition rules.
- Any attempt to manipulate the judging process.

The decision of the jury, technical committee, and organizing committee shall be final and binding.

12. OFFICIAL COMMUNICATION

All official communication regarding the competition, shortlisting, reporting instructions, event schedules, and updates will be shared through NIB's official email channels and website.

Participants are advised to regularly check their inbox, spam, and promotions folders.

Official Website: www.nibindia.org
Email: nationalinnovatorsbattle@gmail.com

A MESSAGE TO OUR FUTURE INNOVATORS

At National Innovators Battle, we believe that every great innovation begins with a question and a desire to solve a problem.

We encourage you to think independently, experiment fearlessly, learn from failures, and create solutions that make a meaningful difference to society.

Remember, the objective is not just to win a competition, but to become an innovator who can shape the future.

Learn • Build • Innovate • Compete

TEAM NIB 2026
National Innovators Battle
Vigyan Pathshala & TeamTalks